Next you'll use psql to modify your PostgreSQL configuration.

Modifying Your PostgreSQL Config File

By getting comfortable modifying your local PostgreSQL installation, you'll be well positioned to confidently edit your production configuration whether you're self-hosting PostgreSQL or using a cloud provider. With cloud providers, you may use a web UI or CLI program to modify parameters, but the basic idea is the same. You modify configuration and either reload the configuration without restarting PostgreSQL or restart PostgreSQL when it's required by a specific parameter.

For your local PostgreSQL installation, you'll need to find the path to the configuration file. Run psql from your terminal, and use the following statement to find the path:

sql/show_config_file.sql

```
SHOW config_file;
```

On Mac OS, the path includes a directory with a space in it ("Application Support") so you may need to surround the path in double quotes.

Open the file with your text editor.

You should now be looking at the contents of postgresql.conf in your text editor. It's a long file. Search within the file for the section called shared_preload_libraries.

The default value might be an assignment to an empty string:

shared_preload_libraries = ''

Next you'll set a value for shared_preload_libraries by setting a value inside the single quotes. Before going too far, you may wish to make a backup copy of this file or even check it in to version control. If something goes wrong, you'll want to roll back to a known good version and restart PostgreSQL.

You'll enable two extensions that are included with PostgreSQL by configuring them in this section of the config file. These extensions will be used later, but for now you're just looking to enable them.

First up is the pg_stat_statements[4] extension. This extension is used to collect statistics about queries that are executing on the server. It will be abbreviated as PGSS. The goal here is simply to practice configuring an extension to learn the process.

4. https://www.postgresql.org/docs/current/pgstatstatements.html